

StandAlone Carton / Pallet / EOL Label System

Plant-Floor Architecture

Daltile plant-floor label printing pipeline — one C# application (StandAlone.CartonUi.exe), deployed to three physical stations, bridging PLC/sorter hardware and thermal printers to enterprise systems: item master data sourced from the Progress OpenEdge database (MDM), and production backflush confirmations sent to SAP.

■ External system ■ PLC / scanner hardware ■ CSV / file ■ Application logic ■ Thermal printer
■ Shared network resource ■ SAP backflush integration

EXTERNAL SYSTEM · MASTER DATA

Progress OpenEdge Database — Item Master (MDM)

`itemdet` + `itemhdr` tables (schema `bcmstr3.df`). This is the system of record for item numbers, descriptions, UPCs, shade/size and pallet packing rules.

scheduled export

EXTERNAL SYSTEM · ERP

SAP ERP

Receives production-confirmation / **backflush** transactions once a pallet is confirmed at End-of-Line.

SHARED INPUT FILE · REFRESHED PERIODICALLY

Item Master Export

`itemdet.csv` (US items) & `mitemdet.csv` (Mexico items) — 43-column exports dropped into the shared `data\` directory. Read by both the Carton and Pallet stations for every label decision.

STATION 1

Carton-Label Printing

MainForm · no launch flag

PLC-driven: prints a carton label as each carton is sorted/stacked.

read: `itemdet.csv`

STATION 2

Pallet-Label Printing

MainForm (manual) & `--pallet`
Operator-driven: scans a carton, prints the pallet label it belongs on.

read: `itemdet.csv`

STATION 3

EOL Scanning

`--eol` → `EolScanForm`

Operator-driven: confirms a finished pallet leaving the line and backflushes SAP.

PLC / SORTER HARDWARE

Nuovofina Sorter PLC

Serial or TCP feed.
Each 65-char frame carries stack #, item

OPERATOR INPUT

Scan / type carton barcode

Operator scans the printed carton barcode (or enters item #/stack #) to identify what's on the pallet.

OPERATOR INPUT

Scan pallet serial

Operator scans the pallet's printed serial as it leaves the line (accepts dashed or bare 12-digit form).

#, and a print trigger flag.

writes

looks up

PRODUCED + READ HERE

`boxes{NN}.csv` & `stackers{NN}.csv`

One row per carton scanned (with computed barcode), plus current stack→item configuration. Appended continuously by the PLC handler; read back for row→grid and prints.

reads

LOOKUP

Match against

`boxes{NN}.csv`

Resolves the scanned carton to its stored barcode, item, and stack — falls back to item# or stack# match if barcode isn't found.

match

validates

APPLICATION LOGIC

Label decision + SATO template engine

Resolves a `.sato` template by label size/type, renders carton barcode + item data, converts to raw commands.

prints

barcode written back

APPLICATION LOGIC

Pallet Query / PalletScanForm

Fetches the next pallet serial (`pallet-serial-{plant}.txt`) and builds the WMS 4×6 pallet label payload.

prints

APPLICATION LOGIC

EolScanForm confirmation

Validates the scanned serial exists in the pallet registry, then logs the scan and builds the SAP confirmation payload.

logs scan

sends

THERMAL PRINTER

Carton Printer

SATO / ZPL / IPL — prints the carton barcode label (barcode, item info, UPC). Barcode is written back to `boxes{NN}.csv` so reprints stay consistent.

THERMAL PRINTER

Pallet Printer

SATO WMS 4×6 pallet label — Tag / SKU / Shade / Plant / Qty / Grade / Shift / Line, with the source carton barcode embedded as a reference.

writes

shared read

LOCAL AUDIT LOG

`eol-scans.csv`

Every EOL confirmation logged locally — survives restarts, backs the "last 15 scans" grid.

OUTBOUND INTEGRATION FILE

`sap-output/*.xml`

One backflush confirmation XML per EOL scan — pallet-level qty (no operation/route split).

SHARED NETWORK RESOURCE

`pallets.csv` — Pallet Registry

Written by **every** successful pallet print (Station 2). Must point to the *same* network path

(`AppSettings.PalletsCsvPath`)
from every station, or EOL can only confirm pallets printed on its own PC.

Deployment note — all four modes are the **same** executable, launched with a different command-line flag (`(none)` / `--pallet` / `--eol` / `--settings`), each with its own local `carton-settings.json` (PLC address, printer address, CSV directory, production line #). Item master files (`itemdet.csv` / `mitemdet.csv`) are refreshed from the Progress/MDM export on a scheduled basis, not real-time. A separate, disconnected prototype pipeline (`StandAlone.Console` / `StandAlone.Worker`) exists in the same solution but is not part of this production flow.